

The Architecture of *Grace*

Visual Anchor Charts

Autism-Adapted Edition · Teacher Supplement

BOOK TWO · THE FRAMEWORK

GRADES 3 · 4 · 5 · LOWER SUPPORT

VISUAL-FIRST · CO-REGULATION · TRAUMA-INFORMED

Ten printable anchor charts · one per page

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FOUNDER

PILOT VERSION · 2026-2027 · CONFIDENTIAL

Before You Begin

What changed in Book Two, and why

This supplement is not a new curriculum. It is the same ten anchor charts from *Architecture of Grace · Book Two · The Framework*, rebuilt by a multidisciplinary team — autism specialist, school psychologist, school social worker, special education teacher, speech-language pathologist, and occupational therapist — with autistic learners with lower support needs held as the design audience from the first line.

What did NOT change

- Every defined construct — *Inner Critic*, *Inner Coach*, *Heavy Backpack*, *Window of Tolerance*, *Three-Part Accountability Map*, *Grace*, *Forgiveness*, *Trust* — appears exactly as the curriculum defines it.
- The theoretical foundation — Brown, Neff, Enright & Fitzgibbons, Worthington, Siegel — is preserved.
- The pedagogy — Heavy Backpack prop, the four Non-Negotiable Agreements, anchor charts built WITH students, Disclosure Protocol — is unchanged.

What is new in every chart

- **A literal-language anchor** — each metaphor is also stated plainly, so literal-processing students have a foothold.
- **Body-first interoception scaffolding** on every emotion-related chart.
- **Scripted sentence frames printed visibly on the chart**, plus *Inner Coach sample scripts* on key charts.
- **A Specialist Note** at the bottom of each chart — what to watch for, what to honor, what to never force.

One protective addition, in two places

The Pause Practice (U4 · L3) and Forgiveness vs. Trust (U3 · L3) carry an added pattern-tracking guardrail. Autistic students at Grades 3–5 are entering the developmental window where friendship-shaped harm becomes possible. The original "charitable interpretation" framing — without this guardrail — can train a child to override accurate threat detection. The construct is unchanged. The guardrail is new.

A NOTE ON GRADES 3–5

Three to five is when masking begins in earnest for many autistic students. The child who looked Level 1 in K–2 may now be working much harder to maintain that appearance — and paying for it after school. Watch for the cost of looking fine.

My Identity Web

All the pieces of who I am

*Build one branch at a time · Each branch holds a different part of
who you are*

BRANCH 1 — Things I LOVE

people · activities · places

*special interests count — they ARE
identity, not distraction*



BRANCH 2 — Things I'm GOOD AT

strengths · skills · gifts

list small ones too — they count

BRANCH 3 — Things That MATTER to Me

values · beliefs · causes · fairness

caring a lot about something is okay

BRANCH 4 — How My Brain & Body WORK

what helps me focus · what helps
me regulate · how I think best

*this is your branch — no wrong
answers*

BRANCH 5 — Still FIGURING OUT

questions · maybes · growing
edges

"still figuring out" is not "bad at"

SPECIALIST NOTE · FOR THE TEACHER

Branch 4 (originally "People DON'T KNOW this about me") has been renamed *How My Brain & Body WORK*. The original branch invited disclosure of private things — and for autistic 3rd–5th graders, that invitation can land as social pressure to share something not yet safe to share. The new framing keeps the function (self-knowledge no one taught me) while removing the disclosure pressure, and explicitly invites students to name how their nervous system actually operates. *Special interests in Branch 1 should be welcomed at full volume — these are not distractions from identity; for many autistic students they ARE identity.* Build one branch at a time. Post BEFORE distributing WS1. Keep posted all year.

Emotions Are Messengers

Where I feel it · What it's called · What it's telling me

Every emotion has a message. Emotions are not problems — they are data about what is happening inside us.

THREE STEPS · IN ORDER

1. Where in my body do I feel it? · 2. What is its name? · 3. What is it telling me I need?

FEAR

often: fast heart · cold belly · alert eyes

Something feels dangerous or unsafe. My body wants to protect me.

SADNESS

often: heavy chest · tight throat · slow body

Something I care about was lost or hurt.

ANGER

often: hot face · tight jaw · clenched hands

A boundary was crossed. Something feels unfair.

JOY

often: light chest · easy breath · wanting to share

I am in alignment with what matters to me.

OVERWHELM · TOO MUCH INPUT

often: noisy head · tight chest · everything is loud or bright

There is too much coming in. I need less — fewer sounds, fewer people, a break. *This is sensory, not behavior.*

ANXIETY

often: spinning thoughts · jumpy belly · can't settle

Something uncertain feels threatening. My brain is trying to predict and prepare.

SPECIALIST NOTE · FOR THE TEACHER

Many autistic students have *interoception differences* — the body sense that delivers emotion-data is quieter or differently mapped. The original chart asks “*What is this feeling trying to tell me?*” — a question that requires the body signal to land first. We add the body-first step. **Two key adaptations:** the OVERWHELM card is reframed as sensory load (not a moral failure), and we list *often* body cues — never *always*, because autistic body maps vary widely. A child who says “*I don't feel sadness in my chest, I feel it in my legs*” is not wrong. Believe them. Build with students; keep posted all year.